

be unfair to award any of the above mentioned recommended solutions the crown, since they are good only for their respective application area. The best performance crown was evaluated based on the overall performance of these printers, taking price into consideration.

The crown was won by none other than the Canon S503D—based simply on its package of overall performance, features and support; no other printer deserved this more.

To adjudge the best value award, it would be an injustice if the HP 3325 was left out on any grounds. No other printer can match the value for money ratio that this printer offers.

Canon S530D

Canon S530D was the most feature-rich printer in our comparison test. Its support for nearly all possible technologies, makes it a one-stop printing solution. Whether printing from a PC or a digital camera, it assures that you have total control over the final output.

The printer comes with a USB 2.0 interface for faster data transfer rate, and a Compact Flash (CF) card reader, that you can insert into any digital camera and then take direct printouts. Canon is thoughtful and generous enough to provide a CF adapter as well.

The printer communicates via an LCD screen that offers full control on settings, such as the paper type, ink quality, etc. It also indicates the number of photographs that you have given to be printed. In case you want to print thumbnails of all the images available on the CF card, you can do so from the LCD console.

Canon has also provided cables for printing from a digital camera, this is quite interesting since up till recently, manufacturer did not even provide the necessary data cable along with their printer. Other details such as the placement of buttons and the compact flash slot—all of which are easily accessible—goes



The Canon S530D was an all-rounder, performing equally well in all tests

Snap to Paper

For those of you who are proud owners of a digital camera and long for a solution that can transfer those wonderful moments onto a paper, there is good news. HP and Canon both offer specialised printing solutions in the form of photo printers.

Although many inkjet printers have photo printing capabilities, they require a PC as an interface between the camera and the printer. Photo printers, on the other hand, allow you to print your pictures directly from the camera. So if you wish to print photos, without a go-between PC, then a photo printer is ideal.

Such printers can typically read different memory media which a digital camera is likely to use. To further simplifying your job, all you need to do is just insert the media into the appropriate slot and out come your pictures.

The only draw back of these photo printers is that they allow printing of 4 X 6 size prints only, for larger prints you have to look to the desktop solutions. HP Photo Smart 130 and Canon CP100 are two such photo printers available in India.



Canon S530D
A Compact Flash slot allows you to transfer images directly from your digital camera

in making this printer a true winner.

HP 3325

Initially, we had our reservations about this cute looking printer, that looked like an infant amongst the others. But, after the conclusion of the tests, we had no doubt about its credibility of performance and price. This little one can dance with the best of them!

With a native resolution of 600 X 600(units), it is ide-



With a great price and good performance, nothing comes close to the HP 3325

Decision Maker			
	Home Printing Solution	Office Printing Solution	Professional Printing Solution
You need	An inkjet printer to print resumes, letters, Web site contents and some occasional photo printouts; very low on price and can compromise on speed	An inkjet printer that allows you to print text and combination documents at good quality and high speeds	An inkjet printer that allows you to print photo-realistic vibrant photos, at high resolutions with good features
Look for	A basic A4 printer that has decent speed, prints in colour and comes with warranty and support	A printer that offers good speed, has adequate connectivity options such as USB, parallel, network IrDA, etc	A printer that sports the highest resolution support, has support for separate ink tanks and produces excellent photo printouts
Our recommendations	HP 3325, HP 3420, Canon S200SP, Lexmark Z35	Epson C61, Epson C82, HP 3820, HP 6122	HP 6122, Canon S530D, Epson 915
Price Range	Rs 3,000 to Rs 5,500	Rs 6,000 to Rs 11,500	Rs 10,000 to Rs 20,000

ally suited to general purpose work, and is a boon for home users. The most interesting talking point about this printer, apart from its sheer performance, is the price. Costing just Rs 3,000, there was no doubt that it should be decorated with the Best Value award in the entire comparison. Also, HP has decided upon a new strategy to counter the growing competition: they have introduced a new warranty type whereby, if your printer malfunctions within one year of purchase, they will replace the entire unit on the spot.

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